World History: The Industrial Revolution & Social Transformation

1. Mechanization of the Textile Industry (1760-1840)

The transition from agrarian handicraft economies to machine-driven manufacturing began in Britain with the steam engine invented by James Watt and the spinning jenny by James Hargreaves.

2. Socio-Economic Repercussions & Urbanization

Rapid factory concentration catalyzed massive demographic migrations toward urban industrial centers such as Manchester and Birmingham, creating the modern industrial working class and spurring labor legislation.